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## Chapter 6 — Group 6

# WILLINGNESS & WILLFULNESS: WHERE ARE YOU?

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[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Answer the questions before coming to group. You will share your responses to the questions in group.]

Understanding the difference between being willing and being willful is important in looking at relationships. The first chapter told the story of the woman who called about her husband. She had tried “everything” to help him. But he couldn’t or wouldn’t stop doing drugs and stealing. He was “willing to do anything to change,” he just needed to find the right program that could *help him*.

A problem in this situation is the difference between being willing and being willful. Yes, he was “willing” to go to treatment. He had been in lots of treatments. He surely wanted his life to change for the better. But he wouldn’t put out any real effort to do what he had to do to change—he wasn’t willful. He placed the responsibility for his change on others. There is a simple, old story that relates to this.

There was this guy who was lying outside enjoying the sun. A storm approached with thunder and dark clouds. “I sure don’t want to get wet,” the guy said. The storm kept getting closer. “God, please don’t let me get wet,” he pleaded. But the storm hit and he was soaked. “You let me down, God. I really didn’t want to get wet.”

God replied, “I gave you legs and enough sense to get out of the rain, you have to have the will to use them.”

### 1. What Is Under Your Control?

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In past chapters you looked at some things in your life that were under your control. List below three things under your control that are *very* important to you. (Examples: health, house, job, career, school.)

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_

### 2. Are You Doing The Things You Need To Do?

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Look at the three things you listed above. Are you doing everything you need to do to control each of them? (yes or no) Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of them? (yes or no) What is the first thing you have to do? When will you do this?

1. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #1? \_\_\_\_\_  
Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? \_\_\_\_\_  
What is the first thing you have to do? \_\_\_\_\_  
When will you do this? (Date) \_\_\_\_\_
2. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #2? \_\_\_\_\_  
Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? \_\_\_\_\_  
What is the first thing you have to do? \_\_\_\_\_  
When will you do this? (Date) \_\_\_\_\_

3. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #3? \_\_\_\_\_  
Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? \_\_\_\_\_  
What is the first thing you have to do? \_\_\_\_\_  
When will you do this? (Date) \_\_\_\_\_

### **3. Not Everything You Do Is Wrong**

There is probably no doubt that some areas in your life are going fairly well. You have the ability of coping with difficulties and being successful. Answer the questions below.

1. Name two areas in your life that are going well.
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
2. List two things that you did for others that really helped them.
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. How did helping these people make you feel?
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
4. Name two areas in your life where you need help from others.
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
5. How can you get that help?
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
6. List three things you do really well.
  1. \_\_\_\_\_
  2. \_\_\_\_\_
  3. \_\_\_\_\_
7. What is the one thing in life that you wish you could get paid to do? \_\_\_\_\_

If you have filled out this chapter before group and successfully shared your responses with the group, you will be asked to move on to the next chapter.